



Harold Walter Tigar

1893 – 1915

Civilian Research

Field Name	Field Data	Source of data
Casualty Name	H Tigar Harold Walter Tigar	CWGC
Date of Birth	C1893	
Date of Death (from Spreadsheet)	9/5/1915 Near Near Klein Zillebeke according to Artists Rifles roll of honour (see below)	CWGC Artists' Rifles see below
Age at death (from Spreadsheet)	22	CWGC
Marital Status		
Children (if any)		
Occupation prior to Call up		
Parents	Son of Walter and Mary Agnes Tigar, of 112, Nibthwaite Rd., Harrow,	CWGC

Listed Address(s)	1911 Nibthwaite Rd, Harrow 1901 23 Maitland Park Villas, St Pancras	1911 census 1901 census
Parents /Fathers occupation	Stock and Share Dealer (LSE)	1911 census
Brothers and Sisters There were 3 brothers total who lost their lives in WW1 according to Harrow Observer Geofrey and Howard died in service. We believe the 3 rd brother who died was Laurence but we believe he did not die in battle.	Frederick Joseph Tigar (older), Laurence Edward Tigar (younger), Geoffrey Herbert Tigar (younger), Wilfrid Joseph Tigar (younger), Edith Mary Tigar (younger)	1911 census
Years at John Lyon School		
University (if any)		
Obituary		
Additional sources of data		
War Memorials:	John Lyon School (plaque)	https://memorials.iwm.org.uk/memorial/11204
	John Lyon School (sundial)	https://memorials.iwm.org.uk/memorial/11318
	Our Lady & St Thomas of Canterbury, Roxborough Park	https://memorials.iwm.org.uk/name/249978
	St John the Baptist, Greenhill, Harrow	https://memorials.iwm.org.uk/name/340819
	Wealdstone Clocktower	https://memorials.iwm.org.uk/name/340688

Military Research

JLS WWI RoH	TIGAR H.W.
CWGC Reference	https://www.cwgc.org/find-war-dead/casualty/1626535/tigar,-harold-walter/
Age	22
DoD	09-May-15
Rank	Lt
Regiment	Middlesex Regiment, 3rd Bn
Organisations must have served or have members who served in the Ypres Salient or the Somme in World War One.	YPRES (MENIN GATE) MEMORIAL
Location	West-Vlaanderen, Belgium
CWGC in process of uploading image of headstones which will give us his age, hopefully.	* Records from the Douai Society website. This indicates he was both an Old Lyonian and a former schoolboy at Douai. Son of Walter and Mary Agnes Tigar, of 112, Nibthwaite Rd., Harrow, Middx. His brother Geoffrey Herbert also fell. Lieutenant Harold Walter Tigar was killed in action on May 9, 1915, at the age of 22, during the Battle of Aubers Ridge. He held a commission with the 3rd Battalion, Middlesex Regiment (Duke of Cambridge's Own), but was serving at the front attached to the 2nd Battalion. : He died near Klein Zillebeke in the Ypres Salient, Belgium. On May 9, 1915, the British Army launched a massive, coordinated assault against entrenched German positions in northern France and Flanders (primarily known as the Battle of Aubers Ridge). The 2nd Battalion, Middlesex Regiment formed a key part of the attacking force. As the men climbed over the parapet to advance toward the enemy trenches, they were immediately caught in a murderous, crossfire barrage of German artillery and heavy machine-gun fire. Tigar was killed alongside dozens of his fellow officers and hundreds of his men within the opening hours of the offensive. Because the battlefield was under constant, intense bombardment for months, his remains were never recovered or identified. MemorializationHe has no known grave and is officially commemorated on the Ypres (Menin Gate) Memorial in Belgium (Panels 49 and 51). He is also remembered on the local war memorial in Wealdstone, Middlesex, alongside his younger brother Geoffrey, who fell two years later at Passchendaele

Story of Sacrifice

Harold and Geoffrey Tigar

The Tigar brothers, Harold Walter and Geoffrey Herbert, were both educated at John Lyon School in Harrow and served during the First World War. Their military careers took different paths, with Harold killed in 1915 at Aubers Ridge and Geoffrey killed two years later during the fighting at Passchendaele.

Harold Walter Tigar (1893 – 1916)

Civilian Life

Harold Walter Tigar was born in Belgium in about 1893 and was the son of Walter and Mary Agnes Tigar of 112 Nibthwaite Road, Harrow. His father was a stock and share dealer on the London Stock Exchange. Harold was an Old Lyonian and also attended the school at Douai. Before the war he studied accountancy and passed his intermediate examination of the Incorporated Society of Accountants.

Military Life and Death

Harold served with the Middlesex Regiment. He held a commission as Lieutenant in the 3rd Battalion but was serving at the front attached to the 2nd Battalion. On 9 May 1915, the 2nd Middlesex took part in the Battle of Aubers Ridge where the Army launched a massive, coordinated assault against entrenched German positions in northern France and Flanders. The 2nd Battalion, Middlesex Regiment formed a key part of the attacking force. As the men climbed over the parapet to advance toward the enemy trenches, they were immediately caught in a murderous, crossfire barrage of German artillery and heavy machine-gun fire. Tigar was killed alongside dozens of his fellow officers and hundreds of his men within the opening hours of the offensive. Because the battlefield was under constant, intense bombardment for months, his remains were never recovered or identified.

Harold was killed in action near Klein Zillebeke in the Ypres Salient at the age of 22. His remains were not recovered or identified, and he is commemorated on the Ypres (Menin Gate) Memorial.

Geoffrey Herbert Tigar (1896 – 1916)

Civilian Life

Geoffrey Herbert Tigar was born in Haverstock Hill in July 1896 and was the son of Walter and Mary Agnes Tigar of Nibthwaite Road, Harrow. He was educated at St. Chr tienne's School, Wealdstone, and the Lower School of John Lyon, where he passed the Junior Oxford Examination. He was also known for playing football. Before the war he worked in an accountant's office in the City.

Military Life and Death

Soon after the outbreak of war, Geoffrey left his position and joined the Artists Rifles in March 1915, going to France in August that year. He subsequently received a commission in the 6th Battalion, Royal Berkshire Regiment, in August 1916, becoming a Second Lieutenant.

On October 12, the Allied forces launched the First Battle of Passchendaele. The assault took place in torrential rain, turning the battlefield near Poelcappelle into a deep swamp of liquid mud and shell craters. Over October 12–13, the 6th Battalion, Royal Berkshire Regiment was tasked with holding newly won, precarious positions and enduring intense, retaliatory German artillery bombardments and machine-gun fire. 2nd Lt. Tigar was killed on 13 October near Poelcappelle during these fierce tactical exchanges. He was only 21 years old. Because his body was never recovered or identified from the chaotic battlefield, he has no known grave. He is commemorated on the Panel 105 to 106 of the Tyne Cot Memorial in Belgium.

Three brothers lost during the war years

Research also records a third Tigar brother, Laurence Edward, who died in the final quarter of 1915. However, he is not recorded by the Commonwealth War Graves Commission or Imperial War Museums. It is likely that he was not in the armed services when he died. Sadly not without precedent, even within the context of bereaved families of John Lyon pupils, the First World War brought the deaths of three sons, Harold and Geoffrey in military service and a third son, Laurence. Two further sons survived the war, a younger brother Wilfred died in 1966 age 65 and an older brother Frederick didn't die until 1954.

Photos



Tigar H (AI enhanced)



Tigar H (Original)

Notes

DOUAI SOCIETY 1914-1918 ROLL OF HONOUR	
Lt. Harold Walter Tigar d. 9 May 1915 (age 22) Middlesex Regiment Harold Tigar was born in Belgium in brother Geoffrey, an Old Dowegian, <i>Memorial: Menin Gate</i>	Lt. Harold Walter Tigar d. 9 May 1915 (age 22) Middlesex Regiment Harold Tigar was born in Belgium in 1893. His brother Geoffrey, an Old Dowegian, also fell. Memorial: Menin Gate



Tigar, H W

Harold Walter Tigar was born around 1893 to parents Walter and Mary Agnes Tigar who lived at 112 Nibthwaite Road in Harrow. He had a brother called Geoffrey Herbert Tigar who was also killed in action. Harold joined the 3rd battalion of the Middlesex Regiment and was awarded the 1914-1915 campaign star medal before his death at the age of 22 on 9th May

1915 in Ypres.

Harold Tigar has passed his intermediate examination of the incorporated society of accountant.

Tigar, H W

Harold Walter Tigar was born around **1893** to parents **Walter and Mary Agnes Tigar** who lived at **112 Nibthwaite Road in Harrow**. He had a brother called **Geoffrey Herbert Tigar** who was also killed in action. Harold joined the **3rd Battalion of the Middlesex Regiment** and was awarded the **1914-1915 Campaign Star** medal before his death at the age of **22** on **9th May 1915** in **Ypres**.

Harold Tigar has passed his intermediate examination of the **Incorporated Society of Accountants**.

Roll of Honour, Artists Rifles

<https://www.mirror-service.org/sites/ftp.ibiblio.org/pub/docs/books/gutenberg/7/5/7/3/75731/75731-h/75731-h.htm>

https://londonwarmemorial.co.uk/view_profile.php?id=117112

✓	1	Tigar Mary Agnes 112 Kilbithwaite Rd, Harrow	Mother <u>Geoffrey Herbert Tigar</u> 6 (Ser). Bn Rl Berks Regt. & 2 nd Lt Harold Walter Tigar, Spec List. 3/Bn Middlesex Regt.	£240	✓ 1918 2 May	1917 1 April 14 Oct	20 35	5 8	15
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Notes regarding the third brother who died during the War years:

Laurence Tigar

- died between Oct-Dec 1915 and his death was registered in the Hendon registration district. He was 20 which gives him a birth year of c1895.
- he is not listed on the CWGC website
- nor is he listed on the IWM war memorial database
- his younger brother Wilfred didn't die until 1966 age 65 so he didn't die in the war, and an older brother Frederick didn't die until 1954 (they were both in the war)
- 1911 census confirms that he was the younger brother of Frederick and Harold and older brother of Geoffrey & Wilfred
- No probate
- Younger brother Wilfred J died in 1966 aged 65 so he didn't die in war
- No obituaries in local newspapers
- Not listed in Find A Grave website

Based on the above we assume Laurence was the third brother to die during the war years, though not in battle.

- N.B. All researches seem to incorrectly link Laurence Tigar to Bertrand Benoit Tigar, the latter was the son of Edward Tigar, so not one of the brothers
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